

ECHOES

Local history, made conversational.

ECHOES lets visitors converse with figures from California history, grounded in public-domain sources, primary records, and curated claim banks. Answers are labeled by evidence. Citations are one tap away. When the record is incomplete, the figure says so.

Not a generic chatbot. History that stays accountable to the evidence.

TRY THE LIVE BETA

<https://echoes-inky-zeta.vercel.app/>



Any phone or computer. No app. No account. **Seven figures live today.**

Note: First question for a figure may take 30-60 seconds while sources load; then it is much faster.

MISSION

- Make local and regional history more accessible and engaging
- Keep AI answers tied to real sources, with visible evidence
- Partner with museums, archives, educators, and societies, not replace them
- Grow from web prototype to **living portrait** exhibit experiences communities can host

Long term: walk up to a portrait that comes to life. Conversation that sends visitors back into cases, maps, and photographs. The free web beta is how we learn what works so we can get there, with partners who try it and share honest feedback.

HOW IT WORKS

- Ask in plain language or tap a starter
- Evidence labels: Documented · Reasonable inference · Contested · Not in the sources
- **Show evidence** for citations · **Hear this** for period voice
- Historic images when the topic fits
- Honest refusal when sources do not support an answer

WHO IS SPEAKING NOW (CALIFORNIA SPEAKS)

Seven figures in the live beta, roughly north to south:

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Mark Twain - Lake Tahoe & Nevada Territory | 4. Myron Angel - San Luis Obispo County |
| 2. Hubert Howe Bancroft - San Francisco | 5. Jesse D. Mason - Santa Barbara County |
| 3. August Hemme - San Ramon Valley | 6. Anita Loos - Los Angeles / Hollywood |
| | 7. Alonzo Horton - San Diego |

Each figure is built from curated sources and ingested public-domain primary texts for that place and era.

WHO I WANT TO PARTNER WITH

Museums · history centers · historical societies · archives · libraries · schools & universities · exhibit designers · mission and heritage sites · cultural centers

PARTNERSHIP (BETA)

- **Free beta access** for your organization and visitors (link or QR). No install. No IT project.
- **Your expertise shapes the product:** try it, then tell me about accuracy, gaps, and visitor fit. That feedback moves us toward the living portrait.
- **Custom figure for your town, region, or exhibit:** collaborative pilot during beta. Source-grounded conversation tailored to your local history, using **your archived documents** and sources you recommend (with your approval before anything goes live).
- Path forward: desk QR → classroom use → living-portrait / physical exhibit pilots.

ABOUT ME · LET'S TALK

I'm **Matthew Kennedy**, Cal Poly MSBA alumnus and San Luis Obispo resident. I built ECHOES to promote history learning and practice responsible, source-grounded AI for education and public interpretation. Happy to give a **15-minute live demo** and discuss a custom figure or exhibit pilot.

Matthew Kennedy · ECHOES

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Live beta: <https://echoes-inky-zeta.vercel.app/>

ECHOES is an AI simulation grounded in public-domain and curated historical sources. Answers are labeled by evidence and can be mistaken. That is exactly why partner expertise matters.